

Budgets 2.0 (Q2 2026)

Direct questions to: [owner] or [#project-slack-channel] | Last updated: [MMM DD YYYY]

Summary

One or two paragraphs explaining the initiative

Team

Owner:	Initiative can have only one owner
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Design:	
Data analysis:	
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Keep informed:	
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Product Spec

This section gives us a consistent way of making sure we're working on the right problems before diving into solutions.

Objective

The objective is to enhance the Budgets journey and leading it to monetization and higher utilisation. Also to deliver all of the things we didn't manage to deliver for Slice 1 and with which we made a trade off.

Research:

1. We are going to monitor the adoption and behaviour of our customers in March 2026 and decide on the priorities based on our learnings

Feature list:

• Drive higher adoption

- Link existing cards to a Budget (reassign a source to an existing card)
- Add some examples for Budgets based on the collected data in March 2026
- Blank page based on Payments 3.0 with the Value proposition
- ~~Enhance the discoverability:~~
 - ~~with introducing Create Budget tiles and buttons on top of Payments 3.0~~
 - ~~with reordering the accounts in the carousel — move Budgets on second place~~
- Better navigation in Admin > Budgets

• Improve the card holder experience [UX/UI]

- it is not clear which card is connected to which budget - visibility is needed

• Drive more spend through the Budgets

- Auto top up rules for Budgets

• Make some money out of it? - Monetisation maybe?

- Analysis based on the data we will collect, can we monetise above 3 Budgets? TBD

• Reposition the Spending limits as a Budget limit

- Introduce Quarterly and Annually steps in the limit

• Insights for the spend in the Budgets

- Monitor if this is needed and provide visibility to the users

• Notifications for budget vs actual and budget vs funds (described below)

• Personalise Budgets

• Round-up card spend and send to a dedicated Budget

Prioritised Items for Slice 2.0

1. Fix wording / copywriting based on F&F Feedback
2. Show to the ECH to which Budget a card is Linked
3. ~~Move a virtual card linked to one budget to another budget. The real thing here is to be able to link virtual cards to any account (be it budget OR an account).~~
4. PLG: Make Budgets more discoverable: On the P+H tab → Budgets tile (see reference Payroll)
5. ~~Introduce auto top up rules for budgets (this seems like a big one to prioritise now)~~
6. PLG: GAS Activity when budget needs to be funded
7. ~~Improve Spending limits: Reposition the Spending limits as a Budget limit~~
 - ~~Introduce Quarterly and Annually steps in the limit~~
7. Budgets Widget
8. Budgets Notifications
9. Auto-suggest Budget “Names”/Use Case related
10. ~~Include transferring funds during the Create Budget Journey (during budget creation → create a card before creating the budget + initiate funds transfer)~~
11. Personalise budgets + add more icons to choose from - Looking at P+H Merge, there’s a big tile which can be used to add a custom picture in the background?
12. Remove the transaction limit on Budget level.
13. PLG: Fund your Budget - CTA to add funds and after that Get a card - spend from this Budget call to action on the Budget’s screen.
14. PLG: Budget - Explainer screen: What is budgets, why would you want to make use of Budgets.
15. PLG: Auto-issue card with the creation of a Budget (not prioritised yet)
16. Be able to share 1 card with multiple users of a Budget (not prioritised yet)
17. ...

Requirements Budgets 2.0

Problem statement p. 1

During our initial internal testing, some concerns over ambiguity and unclear messaging have been raised, work with the UX/copywriting team to address those. Full details here: [🔗 Budgets 1.](#)

[0 F&F Testing & Feedback](#)

Problem statement p. 2

ECH are unable to see that a card is linked to a Budget. That may lead to issues once they have more than 1 card with their company.

Jobs to be done (JTBD)

JTBD 1: Link Issued Virtual Card under Budget_1 to Budget_2

I want to be able to see that my company card is linked to a Budget.

Problem statement p. 3

With the current implementation, whenever you delete a budget, all virtual cards get cancelled. We put a lot of effort into making Users add their cards to Wallets, this takes us back to square 1. We want to be able to keep the issued Virtual Cards and link them new budgets.

Who is it for?

Jobs to be done (JTBD)

JTBD 1: Link Issued Virtual Card under Budget_1 to Budget_2

When I no longer need my card for Budget_1 or don't need Budget_1, I want to be able to link this same card to Budget_2 instead of cancelling it.

When I try to delete a Budget where there are still linked cards, suggest to Link those cards to Budget_2, in case Budget_2 is not created, suggest creating it before deleting.

Rules

A virtual card should always be linked to a Budget pot. One card can get linked to only one budget pot.

The user should be able to Tap on Card_A linked to Budget_1 and link this card to Budget_2.

Problem statement p. 5-6-7-8

Budgets currently feels like "money ring-fencing" rather than true budgeting. Users who set limits lack timely signals when approaching/exceeding them, and there's no continuous on-screen feedback showing "am I on track?" The gap between *pot balance* (available funds) and *budget limit* (planned spend) creates confusion. Without activation nudges, many Budgets remain unfunded or unused.

Why we're doing this

To complete the evolution from "pots" to "Budgets" by:

1. Making limits **actionable** via progressive alerts (50/80/100%) so users can adjust before overspending.
2. Making progress **visible** via an "actuals vs planned" widget so users continuously see if they're on track.
3. Driving **activation** from creation → funding → card issuance → first spend via lifecycle nudges.

This turns Budgets into a spend-control tool that matches user expectations of what "budget" means: plan, track, control.

Who is it for?

Jobs to be done (JTBD)

JTBD 1: Control spending by purpose

When I allocate money to a project/category, I want to see if I'm on track vs what I planned, so I can make decisions before I overspend.

JTBD 2: Be warned at the right time

When I'm approaching my limit, I want timely alerts (not too late, not too often), so I can adjust spending, top up funds, or change the plan.

JTBD 3: Get started quickly

When I create a Budget, I want clear next-step guidance (fund → issue card → spend), so I quickly get value and build the habit.

JTBD 4: Understand funding needs

When my pot balance is lower than my planned limit, I want to know how much more to add, so I can execute my budget plan.

1. Push notifications & GAS Actions (event-driven alerts)

1.1 Setup & activation (all Budget creators)

Drive users down the funnel: created → funded → card issued → spending.

If they've created more than 1 Budget, create a GAS + Push for each Budget. Example: They create a Budget but don't fund → they'll get a GAS activity for this Budget to fund it. They dismiss (or fund doesn't matter) and later they delete the Budget. Some time later they create a

new budget but again don't fund → repeat GAS activities. The only activity that's once per account is "Create a Budget".

If they have 2 Budgets created and both are not funded, they'll get 2 separate GAS activities for both Budgets, independent of each other.

We're never targeting for "Create a Budget" GAS if they're <30 days since they're initial Tide onboarding. All other GAS activities are tenure independent.

#	Push + GAS	Trigger	Send rule	Message	Deeplink to
0	Create a Budget	Member that's past their first 30 days since creating their account with Tide but didn't create a Budget yet.	Once per account	"Set up your first budget to keep spending on track."	Create a new Budget flow
1	Budget created but not funded	Member that has created a budget but didn't add funds for 5 days after creation	Once per Budget	Add funds to {budgetname} to start tracking and controlling spend.	Add money to the created budget

2	Budget funded but no card issued	Budget is opened and funded but no virtual cards linked after 5 days.	Once per Budget	Issue a virtual card for you or your employees to spend from {budgetname} securely.	Issue a card screen linked to the specified budget
3	Card issued but no spend yet	Budget funded and card issued but not used in the past 15 days.	Once per Card	If it is admin card: Use your {budgetname} card for the next payment to track spend automatically. If it is team card: No spend on {budgetname} card yet. Check that your team member has their card and knows when to use it.	Linked virtual card details screen

Goal: increase create→fund, fund→card, card→spend conversion.

1.2 Utilisation threshold alerts (only when limit exists, if not limits are set = no push notifications)

Progressive warnings as spend accumulates in the cycle (daily/weekly/monthly).

#	Push	Trigger	Send rule	Deeplink to
4	50% reached “Halfway there: 50% of your {budgetname}	Utilisation crosses ≥50% in cycle	Once per cycle	Budget screen

	allocation has been used this {period}. [period should be month/week or today without this]			
5	80% reached “Heads up: 80% of your {budgetname} allocation has been used this {period}.”	Utilisation crosses ≥80% in cycle	Once per cycle	Budget screen
6	100% reached {budgetname} limit reached: 100% of your allocation is now used. Adjust the limit or wait until the next period.”	Utilisation reaches =100% in cycle	Once per cycle	Budget screen

Logic: $\text{utilization \%} = (\text{spent_this_cycle} / \text{limit_amount}) \times 100$

Threshold-jump suppression (critical edge case):

If one transaction jumps across multiple thresholds (e.g., 40% → 85%), send **only the highest threshold crossed** (80% in this example), not both 50% and 80%.

Examples:

- 40% → 85%: send 80% only
- 79% → 100%: send 100% only
- 49% → 50%: send 50%
- 51% → 79%: send nothing (50 already passed)

Goal: reduce "surprise" 100% hits; give users time to act.

1.3 Cycle reset summary (only when limit exists)

#	Push	Trigger	Deeplink to
7	New cycle started	Daily/weekly/monthly reset	Budget screen

	New cycle started: your {budgetname} limit has reset for this {period}."	boundary	
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Goal: reinforce the time-bound nature of budgets; clear "fresh start" signal.

2. "Actuals vs Planned" widget (Budgets screen)

Placement: Budget details screen (visible without scrolling).

What it shows (current cycle):

- **Planned** (limit): e.g., £1,000/month
- **Actuals** (spent this cycle): e.g., £420
- **Utilization:** $(\text{Actuals} / \text{Planned}) \times 100\%$ as progress indicator (bar/ring fills 0% → 100%)

Visual:

Simple horizontal progress bar or ring that fills based on utilization. At >100%: full bar + "Over plan" label with variance amount (e.g., +£120 over).

Copy requirements:

Clearly distinguish:

- "This cycle plan (limit)" ← the budget
- "Spent this cycle" ← actuals
- "Available funds in pot" ← cash on hand (if shown)

Funding gap logic (pot balance vs limit):

Definitions:

- `pot_balance` = current funds in budget pot
- `planned_limit` = cycle limit
- `spent_cycle` = actuals this cycle
- `remaining_plan` = `planned_limit` - `spent_cycle`

Rules:

- If `pot_balance ≥ remaining_plan`: ✅ "Funded for plan" (no warning)
- If `pot_balance < remaining_plan`: ⚠️ Show funding gap:
 - Message: "To reach your planned budget, add £X more to this Budget."

- CTA: "Add funds"

Goal: make "budget vs actual" visible at a glance; flag when funds can't support the plan.

Edge cases & suppression

Edge case	Handling
Single transaction crosses multiple thresholds	Send only highest threshold (see algorithm above)
Multiple transactions in one batch	Treat as single utilization jump; apply "highest only"
Refunds/chargebacks	Don't re-arm thresholds within same cycle
Limit changed mid-cycle	Don't trigger pushes from limit edits alone (v1); widget updates instantly
Near cycle boundary (spend + reset)	Apply short suppression window; prioritize threshold push if spend caused crossing after reset

Problem statement p. 10

In the current flow, a Budget can be created and a card linked. However, to add funds, the User needs to go to the budget and initiate funds transfer. This adds unnecessary steps to the JTD.

Why are we doing this?

Funding a Budget is an essential part of the customer journey. We want to make sure users are prompted to add funds once their budget is created.

Who is it for?

Jobs to be done (JTBD)

JTBD: Get started quickly

When I create a Budget and link a card, I want to transfer funds, so I quickly get value and

build the habit.

1. First Time Budget Creation Flow:

Once the Budget is created and a Push Notification is sent. User opens Budget settings → once completed, prompt user to add Funds??? We need to think how can this work.

2. Every subsequent Budget creation:

Same as above but no need for Push notification, the journey can continue from this step forward.

Problem statement p. 11

Today, Budgets look bland. Users get attached to Budgets if they can personalise them.

Why are we doing this?

Improve attachment rate and appeal to using the feature.

Jobs to be done (JTBD)

JTBD 3: Make Budgets my own

I want to be able to personalise my Budgets so they are easy to distinguish.

Requirements:

Design related → can we use the Tile to change the background with an image from the mobile phone's gallery?

Problem statement p. 12

We don't need another Single Transaction Level limit for the Budget. We already have that on per card level.

Requirement:

Remove the Single Transaction Level limit for Budgets.

Problem statement p. 13

Members are creating Budgets but not Getting cards

Requirement: Make “issue a card” the obvious next step after funding

Right now, users can stop at “budget created / funded”. Shift the default path:

- **Post-funding success screen CTA:**

After a pot is funded, show a focused screen:

“Your Budget is ready. Issue a virtual card to spend from it in seconds” → **primary button:**

“Issue card from this Budget”.

- **Inline prompt on funded pots:**

In the Budgets list, for funded pots with no card: a pill or a banner “Spend from this Budget with a virtual card – set limits and keep spend under control”.

Problem statement p.14

Members don’t know what Budgets are, they are not aware how to use them

Requirements:

Create a 1 scree explainer: What is budgets, why would you want to make use of Budgets.

1. Create a budget - ring fence funds
2. Set limits and fund it
3. Assign a Card and start spending
4. Track your expenses, control your finances

Entry points for the Budget explainer:

When Open budget is tapped for the first time be it through GAS, Accounts or any other entry point.

Problem statement p.15

Requirements:

- Create **one company card** that represents a **team budget** (e.g. all SaaS tools for Engineering).
- Allow **multiple users to use that same card** instead of issuing separate cards to each person for that budget.
- Track all spend on that card **in one place**, with real-time visibility and controls (limits, merchant rules, etc.)
- Be able to share the tokens of the card via SMS Link to be used by Employees.

- Every transaction should be attributed both to the **card** (the team budget) and to the **user** who spent, preserving transparency even though the card is shared.

Current situation

Add Flowchart, Figma flows and any known issues

Effort

How long will this take? Pick a rough date. Try to remember Parkinson's Law (things take as much time as you let them) and balance it with the Law of Slack (we never finish things on time.)

Success Criteria

Activation funnel:

- % of created Budgets funded within 24h / 7d
- % of funded Budgets with card issued within 7d
- % of Budgets with card that have first spend within 7d

Limit feature engagement:

- % of Budgets with a limit enabled
- Push open rate / tap-through rate (by type)
- Reduction in "surprise" 100% hits (measured as: % of 100% alerts where user also received 50% or 80% earlier in same cycle)

Widget engagement:

- Budget screen views
- "Add funds" clicks from funding-gap state
- "Adjust limit" actions

Analytics events

- `BudgetCreated`, `BudgetFunded`, `CardIssuedForBudget`, `FirstSpendFromBudget`
- `LimitSet(cycle_type, amount)`, `LimitChanged`
- `SpendPostedToBudget(amount, merchant, timestamp)`
- `UtilizationEvaluated(u_prev, u_new, crossed_thresholds[], threshold_sent, cycle_id)`
- `CycleReset(cycle_id, prior_spent, prior_utilization%)`
- `PushSent(type, budget_id)`, `PushOpened`, `PushTapped`

- `WidgetViewed` , `AddFundsClicked(from_funding_gap)` , `AdjustLimitClicked`

Open questions

1. **At 100% utilization:** Are card transactions declined, allowed, or approval-gated?
2. **Team budgets:** Who receives threshold pushes—Admin only, cardholder, or both?
3. **Setup nudge delays:** What are default X hours/days for empty/no-card/no-spend nudges?
4. **Notification throttling:** Max pushes per user/day across all budgets?
5. **Limit change behaviour:** Should reducing a limit mid-cycle trigger a threshold push if utilization jumps above a threshold?
6. **Forecasting (v2?):** Do we want "projected to hit 100% by [date]" alerts later, or stay with actuals-only in v1?

Non-Goals

Are there any related problems that we want to explicitly ignore for now?

✓ Checklist:

- ☒ Organise Kick-off meeting
- ☒ Create PRD
- ☐ Conduct User Research
- ☐ One pager
- ☐ Workshop(s) with the team to gather ideas and align on direction
- ☐ Technical feasibility
- ☐ *Product Spec* section in PRD done
- ☐ Regular (at least weekly) touch points between PM, PD and Eng

🚩 Design

This section helps us ensure a collaborative and divergent design process.

Research

Links all relevant research

Wireframes

Link to initial wireframes.

Edge cases

Together with the engineering team consider all unhappy paths. Link all relevant documents

Final designs

Link to 'ready to dev' file in Figma

Constraints

What are the key constraints, deadlines, or hard requirements to consider?

 **Checklist:**

☐ Kick-off workshop with the PM, UX Writer and Eng

☐ Regular design reviews with Eng, PMs and stakeholders

☐ List of edge-cases (together with Engineering)

☐ RFC is created

☐ Identify dependencies and contact affected teams

☐ Usability testing

☐ Share designs with other designers from relevant teams frequently

☐ Consultation with Design Systems team

☐ Add designs link to the PRD

☐ Finalised designs in 'ready to dev' Figma file

 Dependencies

Dependency	Affected team	When is it needed by?
Utilization calculator (cycle-aware: daily/weekly/monthly spend aggregation)		
Scheduler for delayed setup nudges		

Threshold evaluation engine with suppression logic		
Widget rendering (progress bar/ring + funding gap state)		
Push notification service integration		

► Data

Tracking requirements

What is needed by the Data team to be able track everything that we want? Link all relevant documents

► Development

Links to all relevant technical documents:

[☐ Member Facing Reviews \(MFRs\)](#)

[☐ Payments](#)

ADR Document

Roll-out plan

What's the release plan?

What did we build?

Add links to RFCs and/or any other relevant technical documentation

QA plan

How will we test it?

✓ Checklist:

- ☐ Design hand-over
- ☐ ADR created from RFC (one example – [ADR-PAY-0035 - Introduction of Business level attribute DEBIT_BLOCKED in Account-Svc](#))
- ☐ Refinement's set up
- ☐ Regular QA sessions with PD (weekly?)
- ☐ Regular sessions with PM and PD to gather feedback
- ☐ [Member Facing Reviews \(MFRs\)](#)

🚩 Post-launch

What did we learn?

Link to relevant dashboards

✓ Checklist:

- ☐ Check the key metrics daily for the first two weeks
- ☐ Regular metric tracking for the 3 months after launch
- ☐ Post-launch handover doc
- ☐ Schedule post-mortem